

USER MANUAL

Inventory Manager

Complete guide to managing products, customers, orders,
and inventory from one place.

v1.0 | Assessment by Ethara AI

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Getting Started

System access, sign up & login

1.1 System Requirements

Inventory Manager is a web-based application. No installation is required. You only need a modern browser and an internet connection.

Browser	Chrome 90+, Firefox 88+, Edge 90+, Safari 14+
Internet	Stable connection required for all operations
Screen	Minimum 1024px width recommended (mobile supported)

1.2 Accessing the App

Open your browser and navigate to the live frontend URL provided during deployment. You will be taken directly to the **Sign In** page.

TIP

If you see a blank or loading screen, check your internet connection and refresh the page (Ctrl + R / Cmd + R).

1.3 Signing Up

New users can create an account directly from the Sign In page.

- 1 On the Sign In page, click **"Create one"** below the Sign In button.
- 2 The form switches to **Create Account** mode.
- 3 Fill in your **Full Name** (e.g. Arjun Mehta).
- 4 Choose a **Username** — must be at least 3 characters, all lowercase recommended.
- 5 Enter a **Password** of at least 6 characters.
- 6 Re-enter the same password in **Confirm Password**.
- 7 Click **"Create Account"**. You are automatically signed in and taken to the Dashboard.

INFO

Demo accounts available: You can also sign in with pre-existing accounts — Username: **admin** / Password: **admin123** | Username: **manager** / Password: **manager123**

1.4 Logging In

For returning users:

- 1 Enter your **Username** in the first field.
- 2 Enter your **Password**. Click the eye icon to toggle visibility.
- 3 Click "**Sign In**". You will be taken to the Dashboard.

WARNING

If you see "Invalid username or password", double-check your username for typos. Usernames are case-sensitive.



Dashboard

Overview of your business at a glance

The Dashboard is the first page you see after logging in. It provides a real-time summary of your entire inventory and sales operation.

2.1 KPI Tiles

Four metric cards appear on the right side of the dashboard.

Tile	What it shows	Note
Total Products	Count of all products in the catalog	All statuses
Total Customers	Count of all registered customers	All records
Confirmed Orders	Orders with CONFIRMED status only	Excludes Pending & Cancelled
Total Revenue	Sum of all confirmed order amounts	Displayed in Rupees (Rs.)

2.2 Orders Bar Chart

The large chart on the left side of the dashboard shows order volume over time. Use the toggle buttons in the top-right corner of the chart to switch views:

- **24 Hours** — shows order counts per hour for the last 24 hours.
- **7 Days** — shows order counts per day for the last 7 days.

TIP

Hover over any bar in the chart to see the exact order count for that time period.

2.3 Low Stock Alerts

Below the chart, a table lists all products whose current stock quantity is below their individual low stock threshold. Columns shown:

- **Product Name** and SKU
- **Current Stock** — units currently available
- **Threshold** — the alert level set for this product
- **Stock Gap** — how many units are needed to reach the threshold
- **Restock** button — opens the product edit form directly

TIP

If the Low Stock table is empty, all products are sufficiently stocked. This is the ideal state!



Products

Add, edit, delete and search your catalog

Navigate to **Products** from the left sidebar. This page shows all products in your catalog with their stock levels and pricing.

3.1 Adding a Product

Click the **"Add Product"** button in the top-right area of the Products page.

Product Name	The display name of the product	Required
SKU	Unique stock keeping unit code (e.g. LAPTOP-001)	Required
Price	Unit selling price in Rupees	Required
Quantity	Starting stock count (cannot be negative)	Required
Low Stock Threshold	Alert when stock falls below this number (default: 10)	Optional
Description	Short product description for reference	Optional
Image URL	Paste a direct image link to show a product photo	Optional

WARNING

SKU must be unique. If you enter a SKU that already exists, the system will show a 409 Conflict error. Use a clear naming convention like CATEGORY-NUMBER (e.g. PHONE-003).

After filling the form, click **"Save"**. The product appears in the table immediately.

3.2 Editing a Product

Click the **pencil/edit icon** on any product row. The same form opens pre-filled with the existing values. Change the fields you need and click **"Save"**. The table updates instantly.

TIP

You can use the edit form to manually restock a product — just increase the Quantity field to the new stock level.

3.3 Deleting a Product

Click the **trash/delete icon** on a product row. A confirmation dialog appears. Click **"Confirm"** to permanently delete the product.

WARNING

Cannot delete products that have been ordered. If a product appears in any order, deletion will fail with a Conflict error. Set the quantity to 0 instead to mark it as out of stock.

3.4 Searching, Filtering & Sorting

Global Search:

Use the search bar above the table to filter products by name or SKU in real time.

Column Filters:

Click the **"Filters"** button to reveal per-column filter inputs beneath the table header. You can filter by price range (Min/Max), stock range, or type partial text in any column. Active filter count is shown on the button. Click **"Clear Filters"** to reset all.

Sorting:

Click any **column header** to sort the table by that column ascending. Click again to sort descending. An arrow indicator shows the current sort direction.

3.5 Product Details Panel

Click anywhere on a product row (not the action buttons) to open the **right-side details panel**. This panel shows:

- Product image, name, SKU, price and description
- Current stock with low-stock indicator
- Insights: total orders, quantity sold, revenue generated, last ordered date
- Recent orders table — last 5 orders for this product

Close the panel by clicking the **X** button, pressing **Escape**, or clicking the dark backdrop.



Customers

Manage your customer database

Navigate to **Customers** from the sidebar. All registered customers are listed here with their contact details and join date.

4.1 Adding a Customer

Click **"Add Customer"** in the top-right corner.

Full Name	Customer's full name as it appears on records	Required
Email	Unique email address for this customer	Required
Phone	Contact phone number including country code	Required

WARNING

Email must be unique. No two customers can share the same email address. This is used to identify customers when placing orders.

4.2 Viewing Customer Details

Click anywhere on a customer row to open the **Customer Details panel** on the right side. It shows:

- Full contact information (name, email, phone, member since date)
- Stats: Total Orders placed and Total Amount Spent
- Last Order Date
- Recent orders table showing the last 5 orders with status and totals

TIP

Email addresses in the detail panel are clickable mailto links. Phone numbers are clickable tel links on mobile devices.

4.3 Deleting a Customer

Click the **delete icon** on a customer row and confirm the dialog.

WARNING

Cascade delete warning: Deleting a customer permanently deletes ALL of their associated orders as well. This action cannot be undone. Make sure you no longer need their order history before proceeding.



Orders

Create and track customer orders

Navigate to **Orders** from the sidebar. All orders are listed here with their status, customer, total amount, and date. Order statuses are shown as colour-coded badges:

PENDING	Order received but not yet confirmed
CONFIRMED	Order confirmed and stock has been deducted
CANCELLED	Order was cancelled; stock has been restored

5.1 Creating an Order

Click **"New Order"** in the top-right corner of the Orders page.

- 1 Select Customer:** Choose a customer from the dropdown. Type to search by name or email.
- 2 Set Order Date & Time:** A date/time picker is pre-filled with the current moment. Change it if you are logging a past order.
- 3 Add Items:** Select a product from the dropdown, enter the quantity. Available stock is shown as a hint. Click **"Add Item"** to add more products.
- 4 Review Summary:** The order total is calculated automatically by the backend based on unit prices at the time of order.
- 5 Submit:** Click **"Create Order"**. Stock is deducted immediately upon success.

WARNING

Insufficient stock: If any item quantity exceeds available stock, the entire order is rejected. No stock is deducted for a failed order. Reduce the quantity or choose a different product.

5.2 Viewing Order Details

There are two ways to view full order details:

- **Quick view:** Click anywhere on an order row to open the right-side details panel.
- **Full page:** Click the view/eye icon on a row, or the **"View Full Details"** button inside the quick view panel.

The full order detail page shows:

- Order ID, status, date and time
- Customer name and email
- Items table: product name, SKU, quantity, unit price, subtotal
- Grand total at the bottom

5.3 Cancelling an Order

Click the **delete icon** on an order row and confirm the dialog. The order is removed and all stock quantities are automatically restored.

INFO

Order cancellation is permanent. Once deleted, the order cannot be recovered. Stock is restored immediately upon cancellation.



Navigation & UI Features

Sidebar, downloads, pagination

6.1 Sidebar Navigation

The left sidebar contains all main navigation links: Dashboard, Products, Customers, Orders, and Help. The active page is highlighted.

Collapsing the sidebar:

At the bottom of the sidebar is a **collapse/expand toggle button**. Click it to collapse the sidebar to icon-only mode, giving your tables more horizontal space. Click again to expand it.

TIP

In collapsed mode, hover over any sidebar icon to see its label as a tooltip.

6.2 Downloading Table Data

Every table (Products, Customers, Orders, Low Stock) has a **Download button** in its header area. Clicking it exports the currently filtered and sorted data as a CSV file — not just the current page, but all matching rows.

Table	CSV Filename	Columns Included
Products	products_export_YYYY-MM-DD.csv	Name, SKU, Price, Stock, Threshold, Description
Customers	customers_export_YYYY-MM-DD.csv	Full Name, Email, Phone, Joined Date
Orders	orders_export_YYYY-MM-DD.csv	Order ID, Customer, Total, Status, Date
Low Stock	low_stock_export_YYYY-MM-DD.csv	Name, SKU, Stock, Threshold, Gap

6.3 Pagination

All tables display **10 rows per page** by default. At the bottom of each table you will find:

- **Row count:** "Showing 1–10 of 45 results"
- **Page controls:** First / Prev / page numbers / Next / Last
- **Rows per page selector:** Choose 10, 25 or 50 rows

TIP

Pagination works together with filters and sorting. If you filter to 8 results, pagination disappears since all results fit on one page.



Account

User profile and session management

7.1 Logging Out

Your account initials appear as an avatar in the top-right corner of the screen. To log out:

- 1

Click your **avatar** in the top-right corner of the topbar.
- 2

A dropdown menu appears showing your name and role.
- 3

Click **"Sign Out"**.
- 4

You are returned to the Sign In page. Your session is cleared.

INFO

Your login session is stored in the browser. If you close the tab and reopen the app, you will still be logged in until you explicitly Sign Out.



Help & FAQ

In-app help and common questions

Click **"Help"** in the sidebar or the Help button in the topbar to open the FAQ page. Questions are grouped by category and expand on click.

Category	Topics Covered
Products	Adding products, SKU rules, low stock threshold, deletion rules
Orders	Creating orders, stock deduction, cancellation, total calculation
Customers	Unique email rule, cascade delete, viewing order history
Dashboard	KPI explanations, bar chart usage, low stock table
Data & Export	CSV download, filter effects on exports
Account	Demo credentials, logging out, session persistence

TIP

The Help page is always available from the sidebar at the bottom, even when the sidebar is in collapsed (icon-only) mode.